



Figure 1: After first login, the beautiful wallpaper

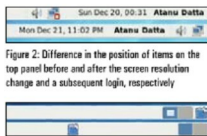


Figure 2: Difference in the position of items on the top panel before and after the screen resolution change and a subsequent login, respectively

primary volume descriptor. This probably means the disc was created without adding the checksum." This is because the LFY CD team has dropped the Omega ISO image after opening the Fedora 12 DVD ISO, and then repackaged it. It's completely safe to skip the media check and proceed with installation—things work fine from here on.

The boot splash

All those stuck with NVIDIA graphics cards have something to cheer about this time. KMS works out of the box—thanks to the work done by Fedora engineers on the open source nouveau drivers. [It already worked on Intel and ATI graphics cards since previous releases.] Now, we all can have the same classy boot splash screens that transform into GDM when X starts—yes, it's flicker-free on NVIDIA as well. A note on the boot splash: it'd be good if the release team updates the artwork in every release to blend with the overall look and feel of the release—for example, the default wallpaper.

The desktop

Users like 'fresh' looks. It comes from the well-known fact: "Pretty is

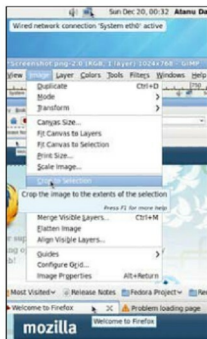


Figure 3: Difference in the position of items on the bottom panel before and after the screen resolution change and a subsequent login, respectively

a feature!" And we've got to hand it to the artwork team for the default wallpaper—it's very pleasing to the eyes. Trust me when I say this is one of the most essential things in any OS. Remember the DNA wallpaper from Fedora (Core) 6? I've heard from a few who were so put off by it, that they failed to give Fedora another try afterwards.

Figure 1 shows the desktop at first login. The resolution is 1024x768; but that's what I get with any other distro as well. By going *System→Preferences→Display*, I could easily change it to my choice of 1280x1024 pixels. On the laptop, it booted to a 1200x800 pixel resolution as expected.

What was a bit disheartening to notice is that NetworkManager showed the network status as disconnected on my first login. Although a simple click and selecting 'System eth0' made it query the router for an IP, and configure it in a few seconds, I would have preferred if it didn't require manual intervention. On subsequent logins, it was connected by default though.

But here's where I noticed a bug. The position of both top and bottom panel items on the right-hand side of the screen change somewhat automatically.



Figure 4: Improved look n' feel for tooltips



Figure 5: New theme for system notifications

Take a look at Figures 2 and 3. After manually setting them in order and upon a re-login, things were still in order. So, it's not much of a headache.

A nice change that's come from the artwork team is rounded edges for tooltips in Fedora 12. Take a look at Figure 4. The only exception I noticed is that tooltips in Firefox still had pointy edges, as you can see in the screenshot. The tooltips will be translucent if you have *Desktop effects* on.

Also introduced is a new style for system notifications as you can see in Figure 5—translucent with desktop effects enabled. In my opinion, the black colour doesn't quite gel with the overall default theme of Fedora 12.

The team has also included special icons for the typical Home directory folders viz., Documents, Downloads, Music, etc. See Figure 6. This is a very smart (and much-needed) move that helps users to easily distinguish the folders, visually.

Anyhow, these are all nice additions from the perspective of giving the desktop a nice overall feel. Good to see Fedora slowly taking a note of these facts. The only thing that remains to be seen is officially